

## MAC OS X

Apple has always been the epitome of easy-to-use products; the Mac OS X is no exception. Here are a few handy tips to further increase ease of use, tricks you never knew and a few interesting software all Mac users must have.

### Spotlight

Let's start with one of the most highly used features of the Mac OS X – Spotlight. It rests on the top-right corner of the home screen represented by a magnifying glass, which you can click to open the feature. Alternatively, press [Command] + [Space bar]. You probably already know that you can use it to search for files, folders or to launch applications. These following tips will help you further filter your search.

### Search in Spotlight

If you search for anything using quotation marks, Spotlight will only look up for files and folders



Search in Spotlight

that contain the exact term inside the quotation mark. You don't need to complete the quotation marks; starting the search with open quotes tells Spotlight that it should search for items that include the words that follow.

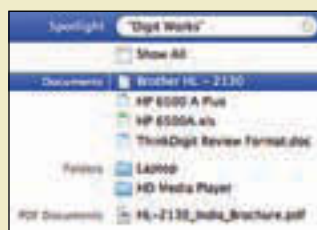
### Search using metadata

Apart from searching for files and folders, Spotlight further searches for metadata, viz file information created during its generation. If you control-click any file or folder and open the Get Info window you'll find all the metadata the file stores. The interesting part here is that the file information is not limited to that data, which means you can add your own keywords to every



|                                   |    |
|-----------------------------------|----|
| Mac OS X.....                     | 83 |
| digikam. ....                     | 86 |
| Data backup on mobile phones..... | 88 |

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Use metadata info to search



Add metadata

file. To do so, in the same Get Info window, you'll find a box that reads "Spotlight Comments:"; here's where you can add your comments. You can now direct Spotlight to search for the file you want based on this data.

### More tips to further limit your search

If you know the exact name of the file for which you're searching, type name:file.

If you know the author of the file, use author:author name.

If you know the type of file, use kind:type of file.



Further streamline your search

You'll be surprised by how much Mac lets you exploit this feature and understands exactly what you need. Your keyword for "kind:" can include almost anything i.e. movies, email, audio, MP3, JPEG, PNG, images, key-note, word, PowerPoint, Quick-Time, PDF, app, etc.

You can also use a combination of all of the above to further narrow down your search.

### Look up definitions with Spotlight

In Spotlight, just type in the word for which you want a definition. You'll see that a short definition appears in the search results. To expand the word's definition just let your cursor hover over it and you'll be able to view the entire definition.



Define words with Spotlight

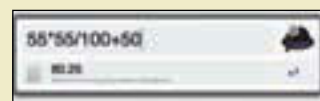
### Calculate with Spotlight

Yes, you can use Spotlight as a calculator, all you need to do is type in the desired math equation. For example, type 55\*55/100+50 and you'll get the answer 80.25. It's as simple as that and you no longer need to find the Calculator app unless you want to perform complex equations. To find the square of a



Find square root

number, just enter pow(5, 2). Likewise you can enter sqrt(number) to find the square root.



Calculate with Alfred

Alternatively you can use Alfred, a productivity application. It's available in both, free as well as paid package. The paid version of the app can increase your productivity manifold. It's a great app to have.